

YOUR MAP'S YEAR

This was BRC Map's first real burn – and instead of freezing the site for the week, we built alongside you, shipping new features almost daily as the city showed us what it needed. You put your camps, your art, and yourselves on the map; here's what grew around your pins.

1,247

CAMPS ON THE MAP

361

ARTWORKS PLACED

~1,700

EVENTS LISTED

0

TRACKERS & ADS,
EVER

THE WEEK THE MAP GREW, DAY BY DAY

EARLY WEEK

The whole city arrived. Alongside the 236 camps who placed themselves, we brought in Burning Man's public placement directory – about a thousand more camps, converted from addresses like "7:30 & E" by our own geocoder – and the official art directory, taking the map from 9 placed artworks to 361 in an afternoon. One rule governed it all, and always will: **a pin placed by a person beats the official spreadsheet, every time.** Not one of your placements was moved. (Layers ▶ "Placement list" hides the directory if you prefer only the camps who opted in.)

MIDWEEK

The map learned to keep you company. BMIR and Shouting Fire moved to one tap from the map, on a player that keeps playing while you browse anywhere on the site; the official webcast joined /live, click-to-load so it never eats your data uninvited. The weather grew up too: the pill now leads with real sensors inside the fence (thank you, BRC NOC), says the dust risk in words – "*Dusty – goggles up*" – and the map itself blows and rains to match the actual sky. We also rebuilt the whole top of the map into one clean status bar, guided almost entirely by your screenshots.

BURN NIGHT EVE

Rideshares launched the night before exodus. Offer empty seats or ask for a ride – destination, timing, luggage, your camp address prefilled – then arrange it in messages. **Connect** went further: two matched burners could share live locations with each other to actually find one another for the pickup, by mutual consent, deleted the moment either tapped stop. We also began mirroring RideFinder's public listings (read-only, credited, replies on their site), so one look showed every ride that existed. The board's very first post helped a stranger get toward home – which is the entire point.

EXODUS

The way out, honestly. A new /exodus page let people actually sitting in the line tap how long Gate Road was taking; the median became the road's live traffic grade, and the road itself wore it on the homepage – breathing green when it flowed, amber, red when it didn't, and going quiet rather than showing a stale number (a confident old "it's clear!" is how surges start). Little taillights crawled out Gate Road, one for every open ride post, at the crowd-reported pace.

ALL WEEK

Off-grid, all along. The map itself needs no signal – it draws with no tiles, your GPS reads as a playa address ("*near 7:30 & Eternal*"), and everything you'd synced worked in the deep dust. Pair a Meshtastic radio and your campmates appear on the map with chat, no internet at all.

NOW

Resto. The city is gone; the sweep remains. Standing on MOOP? Pin it – anonymously, no account – at brcmap.net/resto, category-coded so a line sweep knows what it's walking to. Leave No Trace is a group project, and this is our contribution to the MOOP Map's success.

And running under everything: **no ads, no trackers, nothing that knows who you are.** Visit counting forgets you at playa midnight – that's arithmetic, not a promise. Location sharing only ever existed between two consenting people, kept no history, and deleted itself on stop.

FIRST-YEAR ROUGH EDGES

A project shipping daily during its first burn finds its rough edges in public, and we found ours – a mirrored traffic feed that briefly showed old posts as current (fixed within minutes, with a guard so it can never happen again), a few days of cluttered map-header layouts your screenshots helped us untangle, and a batch-email system that used to stall partway (rebuilt – this very email is the proof). Every one was found, fixed, and tested the same day, and the map ran the entire event without a minute of downtime. Thank you for the patience, and for the bug reports that read like postcards.

NEXT YEAR, IF YOU'LL HAVE US

The exodus meter live before gate opens, deeper rideshare integration, a way for artists to claim their pieces, and the wilder ideas we hope you'll reply with. Tell us what was useful, what wasn't, what should exist – just reply to the email that brought you here. Every reply gets read by a human.

Your camp, art, and placements stay up all year. If anything changed during the week, update it while you remember.

BRC Map (brcmap.net) is an unofficial community project · Pins are approximate; only Placement places camps and only the ARTery places art · Built by burners in partnership with an AI pair – the long-form report, through the eyes of a traffic engineer, the Org, and law enforcement, lives at brcmap.net/aar-2026.pdf